



Transshipment Terminal (ICTT) playing a pivotal role. This strategically located terminal is set to enhance India's maritime trade by reducing shipping costs and positioning Kerala as a global logistics hub.

Kerala has also made significant strides in food processing, biotechnology, and medical devices. Renowned brands such as Synthite, Eastern, and Brahmins have established a strong presence in the food processing sector, while the state's Life Sciences and Medical Devices Parks further reinforce its industrial strength.

The MSME Ecosystem: Backbone of Kerala's Economy

Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) form the backbone of Kerala's economy, contributing 28% of the state's GDP. Over the last three years, investments worth over ₹21,500 crore have been made in the MSME sector, generating employment for more than 7 lakh individuals.

The state government, under Pinarayi Vijayan's leadership, has introduced several initiatives to support MSMEs. These include:

- **MSME Clinics and Help Desks** at local governance institutions to assist entrepreneurs.
- **Enterprise Facilitation Centers** offering end-to-end support through the KSWIFT single-window system.
- **Investment-Friendly Policies**, allowing

businesses to commence operations with an acknowledgment certificate, delaying licensing requirements for up to seven years.

Kerala has also established specialized industrial parks catering to niche sectors, including the Mega Food Park, Life Sciences Park, Defense Park, and Rubber Park. These hubs attract investments, promote innovation, and create employment opportunities.

Investor-Friendly Policies and Incentives

The Kerala government has taken a proactive approach to attract investors. Various incentives have been introduced, including:

- **100% SGST reimbursement** on capital

investments for five years.

- **10% investment subsidy** on fixed capital up to ₹10 crore.
- **Employment incentives** for companies employing more than 50% local workforce.
- **Stamp duty exemptions** and financial assistance for sustainability initiatives and Industry 4.0 adoption.
- **Research and Development funding** up to ₹1 crore for collaborations with universities.

In addition, Kerala's policies encourage the development of private industrial estates and Campus Industrial Parks on unused educational campus lands, fostering an environment of innovation and collaboration.

